Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + cisplatin

Induction: all three medicines on Day 1 every 21 days for up to four cycles. Maintenance: cisplatin stops; pembrolizumab and pemetrexed may continue every 21 days while appropriate. The team agrees duration and review points.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hormones / brain

Pembrolizumab

Unusual weakness, dizziness, headache, thirst or frequent urination: report promptly.

2 Lungs

Pembrolizumab

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment; infection, cancer or clot can look similar.

3 Heart

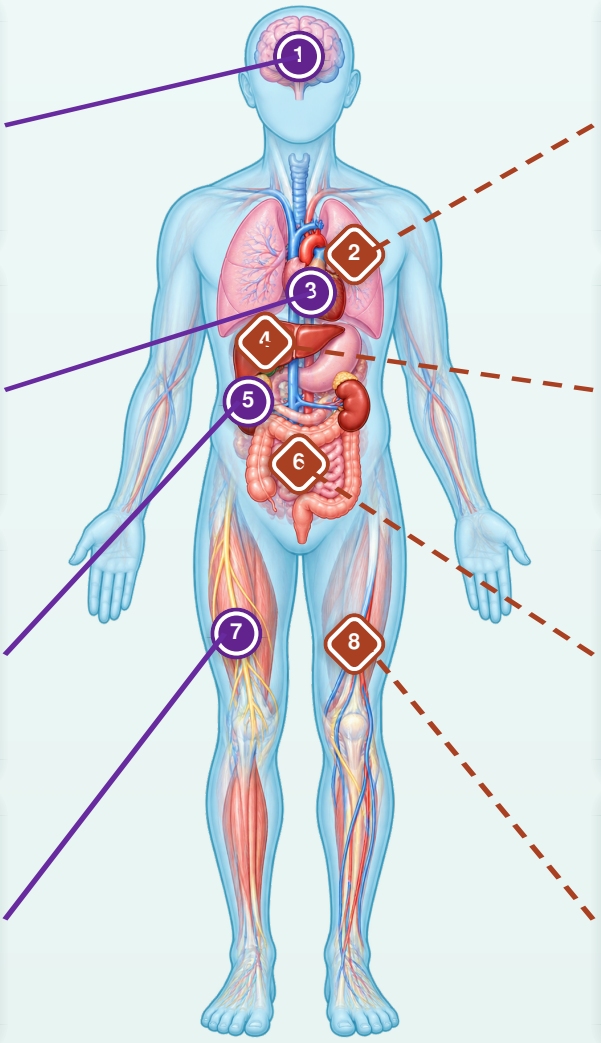
Pembrolizumab

Chest pain, racing heartbeat or fainting needs urgent assessment.

4 Liver

Pembrolizumab / pemetrexed

Yellow skin/eyes or dark urine; tests also check changes before symptoms.



5 Kidneys

Pembrolizumab / cisplatin / pemetrexed

Report much less urine, swelling or persistent vomiting; kidney results affect treatment.

6 Bowel / mouth

Pembrolizumab / chemotherapy

New diarrhoea, severe tummy pain, mouth ulcers or inability to drink need advice.

7 Skin / nerves

Pembrolizumab / cisplatin

Report rash, blisters, numbness, weakness or problems with balance or hand function.

8 Blood / infection

pemetrexed / cisplatin

Fever, shivers or suddenly feeling unwell: contact oncology immediately.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Use the oncology emergency instructions for fever, shivers or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. New cough/breathlessness, severe diarrhoea, reduced urine, confusion or severe rash need prompt advice. Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain, collapse or major bleeding need emergency help. Immune symptoms may start after treatment stops.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Pembrolizumab

- Immune inflammation of lungs, bowel, liver, kidneys, glands, skin and other organs
- Serious infusion reactions
- Effects can develop after treatment ends

Pemetrexed

- Low blood counts and infection
- Fatigue, nausea, mouth soreness and rash
- Kidney toxicity; folate and B12 supplementation are required

Cisplatin

- Nausea and vomiting
- Kidney injury and electrolyte changes
- Hearing loss or tinnitus
- Numbness/tingling and other nerve effects
- Low blood counts and infection

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Induction support

You receive anti-sickness medicines and a fluid plan around cisplatin. Take prescribed folic acid, B12 injections and rash-prevention steroids. Ask for one clear steroid schedule.

Maintenance support

Folic acid, B12 and rash-prevention medicines continue with pemetrexed; cisplatin fluids and some anti-sickness medicines may stop. Immune symptom vigilance continues.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00569/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.